

EPISODE 17 (SESSION 1)

A God Who Hears the Cry

PRIMARY TEXT: EXODUS 4–6

So often we focus on the checkboxes of our faith. What we believe we must do (or not do) to be good enough, qualified enough, or experienced enough. (Sounds like a few of the characters we've met so far in the Story.) That's not to say those things don't mean anything, but is that where our focus belongs? Is that where God's focus lies? So far in the Story, it sure doesn't sound like it.

“God isn’t interested in your qualifications.”

As Marty argues, “God isn’t interested in your qualifications. He’s interested in your availability.”

Have we made ourselves available to God, or have we busied ourselves with our own priorities?

At Impact Campus Ministries, we emphasize creating space in our lives for God to fill—and we trust God to fill it! Have we created this space? Or have we filled the margins of our lives with so many distractions that our souls have to crack for God to get our attention?

In the beginning of Exodus we see this of Moses. He fears his qualifications, his past, his future. Overwhelmed by these anxieties, he either no longer hears or wants to forget the cries of his oppressed people in Egypt. But his God is a God who doesn't forget. God is a God who hears the cries of the oppressed, the weary and marginalized and broken and outcast, and He seeks to restore His people, the world, and humanity—to bring peace to the chaos.

What if we purposefully lived our lives imitating this? What if older generations all modeled this partnership and availability to God for younger generations like we hope to see with our college students? We don't come in with degrees and pomp and circumstance believing we're most qualified to do God's work or define God's work, but instead sought to learn and do and be better, always on the lookout for what God is asking us to *do* now—and next.

Have we filled the margins of our lives with so many distractions that our souls have to crack for God to get our attention?

As we've journeyed through the Story so far in Genesis, we've been shown what this can look like. If we are to partner with God as He asked Israel to, and will continue to through the story of the Exodus, there's no better way than to create that space, to make ourselves available—to partner with Him in His image. Do we create space to hear the cries of the oppressed? Do we seek to bring shalom and restore peace rather than wrath or condemnation?

Do we model justice that seeks to restore the world as it should be? Justice that doesn't overlook wrongdoing and evil, but doesn't just punish sin to punish sin. Justice that looks for ways to restore peace because we *choose* to love like He loves.

Do we try to run or vacate the responsibilities God has given us? Does it take the actions of a woman like Zipporah, who acts in faithfulness to a God not always hers, to convince us that we should partner with Him even in the most uncomfortable of battles and journeys?

**Justice that
looks for ways
to restore peace
because we
choose to love
like He loves.**

The week this reboot episode airs is the week of the funeral of Pope Francis. A man who had all of the qualifications, but whose legacy lies with a call to Christians, the world, to hear the cries of the oppressed. What can happen when we aren't listening, aren't making ourselves available to God?

Almost without being aware of it, we end up being incapable of feeling compassion at the outcry of the poor, weeping for other people's pain, and feeling a need to help them, as though all this were someone else's responsibility and not our own.
—Pope Francis

If we are to partner with God, it is our responsibility as well. We should be aware. We should seek to come alongside Him and be a people that hears the cry. And if we do hear it, what will we do about it?

PRAYER

*To the God who hears **their** cry,
Bring Your peace and restoration
to the broken and oppressed in our world.
To the God who hears **our** cry,
Let us trust that you see us, hear us,
and cry with us.
To the God who hears **my** cry,
Thank you for listening, for meeting me in my pain,
freeing me from my chains.
Let us be a people who hear the cries
of the cast out, the broken, and abused.
Who move beyond our insecurities to step in
and restore justice, hope, and peace with You
wherever we go.*

Amen

THE FOUR PILLARS

EPISODE 17

BEMA Discipleship is built on four pillars; a **Four-Pillared Perspective** to help us remember **to elevate the words of God** (not ours) and help us identify the principles that we see recurring in the Story of God's people.

Here are some applications for this episode echoing the ideas of the four pillars:



TEXT

How could you meditate over these parts of the Story? What Text could you continue to meditate on, memorize, or dig deeper into? What Text might you need to go back to and review?



COMMUNITY

In what ways does your community create space to make themselves available to God? How might you find ways to restore peace to those in chaos around you?



DISCIPLESHIP

Who in your life would benefit from a mentor-like relationship that encourages restoration over punishment? How might a relationship like this help bring people out of oppression? How might you disciple those ready to act and to move in ways of hope and restorative justice?



WRESTLING

What questions do you have after this lesson? About Zipporah's role? Moses's qualifications and availability? The deeper ideas behind that of mishpat? Wrestling is good—even if we feel like we have more questions than answers.



Are you a music listener?

Listen along to our BEMA Music Playlists on Spotify.

Song suggestions? Send them to bemabesorah@gmail.com.



BEMA SESSION 1



MEDITATION & PRAYER

REFLECTION, APPLICATION & IMPACT

There are three emphases we are always thinking about in terms of application at BEMA. These may be stated explicitly at times, but often we will want you to do the work of finding ways to connect the dots to the things we are learning. Much of this is what makes the work of BEMA distinct as a ministry of Impact Campus Ministries.

CREATING A SPACE SPIRITUAL FORMATION

We believe that **if we do our part of creating space for God, He will fill it.** We want BEMA to foster practices that enable the Holy Spirit to do a work in and through us all so that we are readily available to be used by God to restore peace and hope in our communities and around the world. How have you created a space to hear God speak to you? How might you be ready to respond? What spiritual practices might help you enter into this space with God as well as prepare you to hear Him?

CONSIDERING CAMPUS YOUNG PEOPLE FOCUS

We believe young adults are shaping the future of this world, and they need the mentorship or guidance of people like you. They need to see generations before them actively caring about the poor and oppressed. They are a generation of world-changers, and hearing that God is a God of love and peace—not fire and brimstone and wrath—could be life changing. What young person near you may God be bringing into your life to share this truth with?

SACRED STATION THEOLOGY OF WORK

This isn't just for our time at church or Bible study; this is about what we do at work and in our everyday lives. How can we combat oppression, be a voice for the voiceless, and be a blessing to the world during our 9–5? Does our physical work bring shalom or chaos? Do we create space to hear the cries of the oppressed or wronged? The way we manage our employees, interact with customers or coworkers, care for our children, or create products can and should bless others. **The work we do every day, and how we approach it, is sacred and matters!**